Rivermouth Water Quality Report 2026

I. Introduction

This report presents the quality of the water of the Rivermouth estuary measured between March and September 2026 by the municipal environment department.

II. Sampling

A. Sites

Five sampling sites, S1 to S5, were visited every two weeks. Site S3 lies downstream of the outlet of the treatment plant and site S5 at the mouth of the estuary.

B. Methods

Nitrates were measured by ion chromatography and Escherichia coli by membrane filtration, within six hours of each sampling.

III. Results

A. Nitrates

Nitrate concentrations stayed below the drinking water limit of 50 milligrams per litre at every site. The highest values were recorded in May, after heavy rain on the farmland upstream.

Site	Mean (mg/L)	Maximum (mg/L)
S1	12	19
S2	15	24
S3	21	38
S4	17	27
S5	9	14

B. Bacteria

Escherichia coli exceeded the bathing water threshold twice at site S3, on 14 May and on 2 July. Both events followed a storm overflow of the sewer network.

IV. Conclusions

The department recommends a second storage basin at the treatment plant, so that storm water no longer reaches the estuary without treatment.

References

[1] Estuary Monitoring Network. Sampling protocol for coastal waters, third edition, 2024.

[2] Municipal Environment Department. Rivermouth water quality report 2025.

Appendix A. Laboratory

All analyses were made by the Coastal Analysis Laboratory, accredited under the number LAB-4471 for nitrates and microbiology.